

AI Traffic Light — Data & Tools Guide

[ORGANISATION NAME] • one page • pin it up

Before you use AI, check the light. Match the information to the category, not the tool to the task. When in doubt, leave it out.

What data can go into AI?

	Level	Examples	What to do
●	GREEN — safe	General, non-personal, already-public information: public info, general research, admin drafting with no names, marketing copy for review	Go ahead. A person still reviews the output.
●	AMBER — caution	Internal but not sensitive; must be de-identified first: internal drafts, meeting summaries with names removed, aggregated non-personal figures	Strip out names and identifying details before you paste.
●	RED — never	Personal, confidential, or legally protected: names + personal details, financial records, health / pastoral / counselling notes, HR files, anything shared in confidence	Never enter into a public AI tool. NZ Privacy Act 2020.

Which tools can I use?

	Tier	Rule
●	Approved	On our Approved AI Tools list. Use within our guidelines.
●	Provisional	Under trial by staff only. No personal data. Not yet for frontline / service use.
●	Unapproved	Not assessed, or failed assessment. Do not use for [ORGANISATION] work. Any tool that can't show NZ Privacy Act 2020 compliance sits here by default.

Five questions before you hit enter

1. **Personal or confidential info** about anyone we serve? → If yes, **stop**.
2. **Comfortable being transparent** about AI's role, if asked? → If not, rethink or disclose.

3. **Verified** it for accuracy and appropriateness? → If not, do that first.
 4. **Replacing human attention** someone deserves? → If yes, choose the person.
 5. **Approved tool?** → If not, check first.
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Three traps to watch

 **Meeting bots.** Never let AI meeting assistants — Otter.ai, Fireflies, Read.ai, Teams Copilot, and similar — join a confidential meeting (pastoral, prayer, safeguarding, HR, or anything Red-category). They can join calls automatically. Check before the call starts.

 **AI gets it wrong.** AI invents facts, quotes, dates, statistics — and Bible verses — that sound completely real. Check everything before you publish, present, or teach it.

© **Paid and licensed resources.** Don't upload licensed or purchased material (curricula, training content, paid resources) into public AI tools. It can breach the creator's copyright and expose paid material to public training data.

Made a mistake? Tell someone straight away.

If Red — or sensitive Amber — information ends up in a public AI tool, tell **[LEADERSHIP / the person responsible]** immediately. Leadership makes the legal call (including any reporting obligation), not you. **Nobody is in trouble for reporting honestly.**
